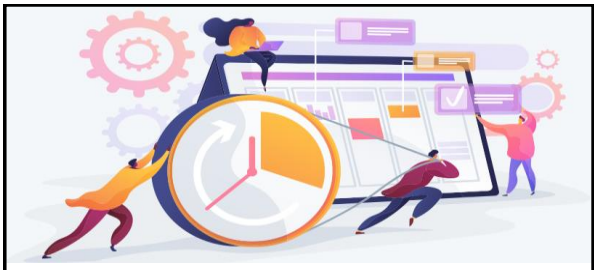


Topic # 10B
Project Human Resource Management - Planning & Managing Team
Chapter 9, 10 - Schwalbe
Chapter 9 - PMBOK, Reference



Improving Effectiveness

Stephen Covey has given 7 approaches to help people and team becoming more effective.

1) **Be Proactive**
2) **Begin with the end in mind**
3) **Writing Mission Statement for the project**
4) **Put first things first**
5) **Think win/win**
6) **Seek first to understand, then to be understood**
7) **Synergize:** Collaboration is important
8) **Sharpen the saw**

- Good project managers are **empathic listeners** - they listen with the intent to understand
- Before you can communicate with others, you have to have **rapport** – a relation of harmony, conformity, accord, or affinity
- **Mirroring** is the matching of certain behaviors of the other person, a technique to help establish rapport
- IT professionals need to develop empathic listening and other people skills to improve relationships with users and other stakeholders.



Motivation Applications

- Management by Objectives: A program that encompasses specific goals, participative set for an explicit time period with feedback on goal progress.
- Employee Recognition Program: Recognize individual and group accomplishments
- Employee Involvement Program: It is a participative process that uses the entire capacity of employees and is designed to encourage increased commitment to organization's success.
- Job Rotation, Job Enlargement, Job Enrichment, Flex Time & Job Sharing, Telecommuting
- Variable pay plans such as piece rate pay, profit sharing, gain sharing & bonuses
- Flexible Benefits: Employee choose benefits from a menu of options.



Team Development

- The main goal of **team development** is to help people work together more effectively to improve project performance
- It takes teamwork to successfully complete most projects
- **Tuckman Model of Team Development:**
  - Forming
  - Storming
  - Norming
  - Performing
  - Adjourning



- Training can help people understand themselves, each other, and how to work better in teams
- Team building activities include
  - physical challenges
  - psychological preference indicator tools



Team – Decision Making

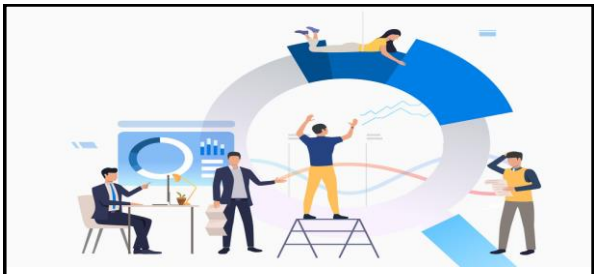
- delegate to subteams when possible
- let everyone give their input
  - even if some of it is off-track
- write down pros/cons of alternatives (weighted?)
  - evaluate cost/benefit/risks
  - How long will it take? How much to learn? Do we have to do it?
- have a clear procedure for resolving disagreement
  - strive for consensus, but if it cannot be achieved, ...
  - majority vote, and PM decides on a tie, ... etc.
- Pareto analysis: find 20% of work that solves 80% of problem
- compromise, compromise, compromise

- **Once decision are made ....**
  - write down decisions and responsibilities clearly
    - document by email
    - post to a shared wiki or web page
  - come up with a set of steps to accomplish the decided goal
    - list specific dates that progress should be made
    - list several smaller milestones
    - agree to communicate and/or meet after milestones are done
  - prioritize and order goals and TODOs
    - list them by urgency, by due date (or milestone date)
    - make sure to list group member(s) are responsible for which
    - make sure every group member has a significant role

Reward and Recognition Systems

- Team-based reward and recognition systems can promote teamwork
- Focus on rewarding teams for achieving specific goals
- Allow time for team members to mentor and help each other to meet project goals and develop human resources





Managing the Project Team

- ***Project managers*** must lead their teams in performing various project activities
- After assessing team performance and related information, the project manager must decide
  - if changes should be requested to the project
  - if corrective or preventive actions should be recommended
  - if updates are needed to the project management plan or organizational process assets.
- ***Tools and Techniques for Managing Project Teams***
  - Observation and conversation
  - Project performance appraisals
  - Interpersonal skills
  - Conflict management



Achieving Team Productivity

Achieving Team Productivity

- How can you get the most out of your team members?
  - give them specific, small, attainable goals that they can visualize
  - have frequent communication and updates
  - meet in person to work as much as possible
  - put people in small teams; minimize work done "solo"
  - build good team camaraderie
- What can block people or stop them from making progress?
  - technical confusion: *How do I start implementing that feature?*
  - unclear responsibilities: *Oh, am I supposed to do that?*
  - unclear due dates: *When was I supposed to have that done?*
  - lack of milestones: *But it's not due until next Friday!*
  - laziness: *Time to work on 403 ... Ooh look, World of Warcraft!*

Achieving Team Productivity

Dealing with slackers

- What do you do if a group member is slacking off instead of working?
  - check up on them frequently
  - give them less "solo" work; put them in a sub-team of 2-3
  - have them meet more in person (harder to slack in front of you)
- If the problem persists, then what?
  - anonymous feedback
  - have the PM send them a kind but firm email with concerns
  - have an in-person meeting with PM and a few members
  - contact primary customer to let them know about potential issue

Achieving Team Productivity

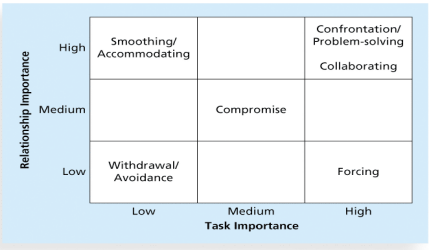
- Handling Slackers … continued
  - group relations must be handled with care
    - "slacker" may feel singled out by rude or critical messages / meetings
    - There are two sides to every story.
    - goal: to improve problem and maintain positive group relations
    - it is possible to be critical without being harsh, rude, mean
    - it is often helpful to avoid the appearance of a 1-on-1 conflict
      - PM can speak on behalf of other group members
        - "We" are concerned about XYZ, not "I"
    - depersonalize by making it about all group members, not one
      - "We" are a little behind, so let's all meet in person in the lab today



Conflict Handling Modes

Confrontation	Directly face a conflict using a problem-solving approach
Compromise	Use a give-and-take approach
Smoothing	De-emphasize areas of difference and emphasize areas of agreement
Forcing	The win-lose approach
Withdrawal	Retreat or withdraw from an actual or potential disagreement
Collaborating	Decision makers incorporate different viewpoints and insights to develop consensus and commitment

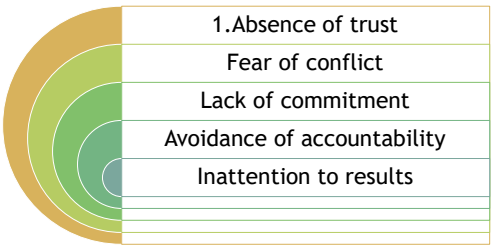
Conflict Handling Modes



Conflict Can Be Good

- Conflict often produces important results, such as new ideas, better alternatives, and motivation to work harder and more collaboratively
- **Groupthink**: Conformance to the values or ethical standards of a group. Groupthink can develop if there are no conflicting viewpoints
- Research suggests that task-related conflict often improves team performance, but emotional conflict often depresses team performance

Five Dysfunctions of a Team



General Advice on Teams



Results-driven structure

- Clear roles and responsibilities
  - Each person knows and is accountable for their work
- Monitor individual performance, hold people accountable
  - Who is doing what, are we getting the work done?
- Effective communication system
  - Available, credible, tracking of issues, decisions
- Fact based decisions
  - Focus on the facts, not the politics, personalities, …

END OF TOPIC 10

- COMING UP!!!!!!
- Agile & User Stories
- Concluding Topics
- Semester Exam & Project
- Project Demo